

THE VOICES BEHIND THE NAMES

Watson survived. For a few hours, that was enough. Then the objects left at Silvertown began to speak.

Stokes's laptop showed a hurried attempt to erase recent activity. One communications client remained, but its account, server, and purpose were still unknown.



The machine was sealed for examination. The task was simple to state and difficult to prove.

Investigators had to recover what survived the wiping attempt and determine how the laptop connected Stokes to the wider operation.



The examination confirmed that Stokes had communicated through a private network under an alias. That solved how he received orders, but not who directed him.

Access opened a wider question. Holmes needed to understand which voices belonged together and where instructions travelled when public conversation stopped.



The restricted spaces revealed an operation built from narrow compartments. Each participant knew one piece, names changed often, and nobody appeared to see the whole design.

The same machinery had directed Watson's movement. Mycroft studied the pattern and admitted that it reached dangerously close to his world.



THE FALSE EMPLOYEE

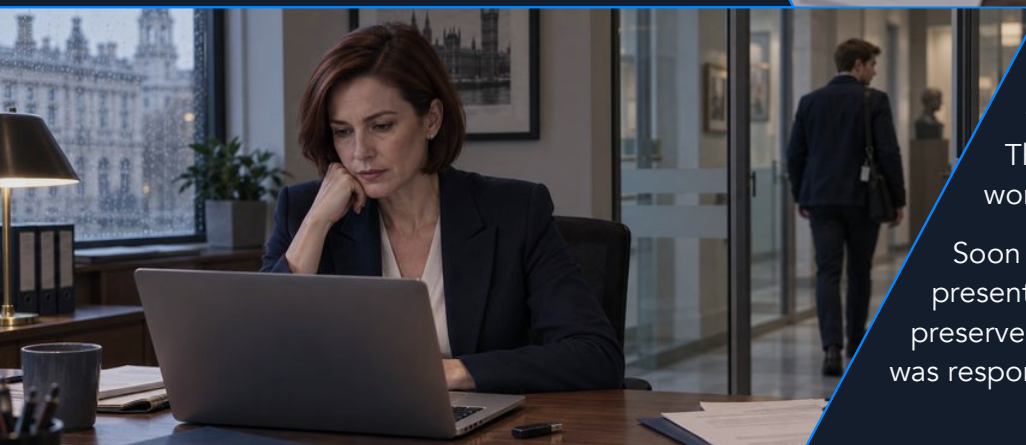
A recent contractor had passed every check, received a badge, and entered the building without challenge. Nothing in the routine paperwork looked alarming.

When the records were examined together, small inconsistencies appeared. Lestrade sealed the files before anyone decided they were harmless.



One contractor badge had entered the corridor near Clara Voss's office. The visitor looked like any support worker carrying routine equipment.

Soon afterward, Clara used a device presented as an update. Her workstation was preserved, but what had happened and who was responsible remained unproven.



POST-SOLVE CONTENT HIDDEN
REVEAL AFTER SHERLOCK